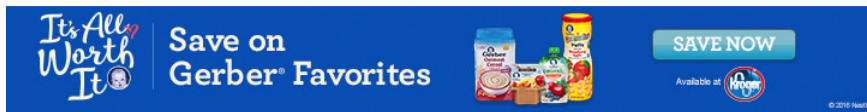


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Ex-sheriff Baca is honored by Congregation Bais Naftoli while awaiting sentencing

by Ryan Torok

Posted on May. 31, 2016 at 3:32 pm



From left: Carol Chiang, wife of former L.A. County Sheriff Lee Baca, Baca and Congregation Bais Naftoli President Andrew Friedman. Bais Naftoli honored Baca, a convicted felon, on Sunday. Photo by Ryan Torok

"I'm not afraid of jail. I'm not afraid of anything."

That's what former Los Angeles County Sheriff Lee Baca — who could face up to six months in prison after pleading guilty in February of lying to federal investigators in a jail abuse probe — told the Journal in an interview after he was honored May 29 at Congregation Bais Naftoli for his years of friendship to the Jewish community.

"I'm one that believes if you know how to suffer properly, you don't suffer at all," Baca said. "I'm an individual who does not suffer because of mistakes. I'm someone who learns from mistakes. ... I'll stand on my record proudly, anywhere, whether it's in the free world or in jail."

Baca's legal troubles came after an investigation into corruption and civil rights abuses at L.A. County jail facilities in downtown Los Angeles. His May 16 sentencing hearing was postponed — details about when his sentencing will take

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place were not immediately available — but Baca said he is not concerned about what fate may await him. The 74-year-old member of the Catholic community said only God can truly judge him.

“I’m not asking for forgiveness for the mistakes that I’ve made. I’ll let God decide to forgive me. I can serve time, I don’t care what the circumstances are, I’m not afraid of that, because I know who I am, I know why I do what I do and I know the people who work for me know that I love them,” he told the Journal at the conclusion of a breakfast celebrating Bais Naftoli’s 24th anniversary. “And I love my critics, as well.”

Bais Naftoli honored Baca, who joined the sheriff’s department in 1965, for nearly 50 years of service to the county community and for his longstanding friendship to the local Jewish community and to Israel, according to synagogue President Andrew Friedman. He said he does not think the former sheriff’s conviction will tarnish what is an otherwise productive record of accomplishment over the many years Baca ran the department.

“I am positive that if Lee Baca were to run for re-election today, he would win in a landslide,” Friedman said to applause on Sunday, before presenting Baca with an award of honor celebrating his 49 years of “exemplary service.”

“Lee Baca was the choice of millions and millions of Angelenos when he ran in 1998 and he and I are social friends as well, and whenever we go out, we are bombarded by supporters.

“We all support you, Lee, and we all love you,” Friedman said.

Attendees at the breakfast included Baca’s wife, Carol Chiang, and former Los Angeles Mayor Antonio Villaraigosa, who told the crowd Baca deserves better than some of the criticism that has come his way in the wake of the conviction.

“We live in a time when too many are quick to demonize and castigate those who have made mistakes. ... As a God-fearing man, I believe in redemption and forgiveness ... second chances — isn’t that what it’s about?” the former mayor said.

Other local leaders in attendance included L.A. City Councilmen Paul Koretz and Mitchell Englander and L.A. County Supervisor Mike Antonovich, who were seated at the main banquet table with Baca at the Orthodox shul. Men and women were seated separately in the venue, which is located on La Brea Avenue.

More than 100 people turned out at the event, which also honored Bais Naftoli young leaders Shlomo Frankel and Lavie Klein.

Baca did not mention the controversy during his acceptance remarks. Instead, he focused on his admiration of the Jewish community for its commitment to education and discussed his upbringing in Boyle Heights, which helped plant the seeds that grew into his love of the Jewish people.

He said he has learned valuable lessons from years of law enforcement work.

“You cannot be in law enforcement if you cannot love people,” Baca said.

Baca, the 18th person convicted of federal charges in connection with the investigation, said jailing deputies will not solve the problem of inmate abuse. “Anybody who deals with a crisis involving risk and force is going to have

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by 7

He said that Men's Central Jail, which holds 8,000 inmates awaiting prison sentences, is among the world's largest jails and that, given its size, it's doing a fine job.

"There is no safer jail of that size," he said.

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Violet Blue and the "Moose Lodge"

Update: Stand-up guy Leo LaPorte responds! See the update at the end of the post.

Update: Hell, yeah! The eternally rocking Patrick Norton agreed to let me quote his response email, head on down to the end of the post to see it.

Chronicle sex columnist Violet Blue makes a stir on the SFGate [every Thursday](#) (if you're not reading her, you should!), and [yesterday's column](#) was no exception. Even amidst the [TourkGate mania](#) that brought so much traffic that our site was limping along until late morning, Violet's column was solidly in our top ten for the day.

So what did Violet say that could possibly be any hotter than an admitted affair between two [attractive](#), [powerful](#) people? How about taking on notable web innovators [John Dvorak](#), [Leo LaPorte](#), [Patrick Norton](#), and [Robert Heron](#)?

In [LaPorte's this WEEK in TECH \(TWiT\) podcast](#), LaPorte and friends gently mock Forbes' [The Web Celeb 25 list](#) on which [LaPorte is #17](#), and Violet Blue is [#25](#).

From her column:

TWiT's lineup this week of LaPorte, John Dvorak, Patrick Norton and Robert Heron had little nice to say about the list or about the women on it. The whole podcast has an old-techie Moose Lodge feel to it: They even spend a minute making fun of one woman's name. But when John Dvorak asks, "Violet Blue



By Violet Blue

Violet Blue and her "Blogger" tattoo

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making fun of one woman's name. But when John Dvorak asks, "Violet Blue, who's that?" Leo LaPorte answers, "She's that ... porn person." "Oh," Dvorak responds. "I ran into her once ... mumble, mumble, mumble."

Are we still saying "oh no he DIDN'T"? I'm thinking that we're not. But if we were...

Read Violet's column for more on why she's so pissed at these guys now, and check out (may not be safe for work, depending on the liberalism of your workplace) [her blog](#) for the responses she's received as a result.

Of course I emailed a link to her column to the TWiT guys. Hey, why not? I love a good fight. Dvorak's game for anything, and [posted a reply on his blog](#).

Anyway, Violet got personally bent out of shape, called us a bunch of pigs in a long-winded rant in SFGate (cited here) and I want to personally apologize for being too glib about her on TWiT. She does good work and I never said she was a bad person. So I'm sorry. That said, she still shouldn't be on the list. Let's be real.

While LaPorte responded to my email, he asked that he not be quoted. Of course, I'll respect that, though I'm totally dying to tell you not only about what he had to say (suffice it to say that he was not amused) but about Patrick Norton's gallant email defense* of Violet and her work. Sorry, folks, but unless they consent to being quoted, it's between me and my inbox. But, trust me, it's good stuff.

Then again, it's all good stuff, perfect to contemplate on a Gavin-fatigued Friday afternoon. So, take a look at [Violet's column](#), [Dvorak's response](#) (ooh, and check out the comments there -- there are some good ones), and (probably NSFW) [her blog](#). What do you think of her beef, and of the responses she's gotten? Let us know in the comments.

*** Update:** Well, it's hard to get the complete context without LaPorte's email, but you can guess that he wasn't too conciliatory in tone in his response to me. Fellow TWiT podcast participant Patrick Norton then sent the following:

Eve, I just re-read Leo's email, and I'd like to apologize on his behalf for still being so clueless about Violet's work. Misinformed on the spot during a live recording is one thing, but misinformed w/out a deadline is just embarrassing.

Leo, 3 minutes on Google would have left you a lot less clueless about the actual content of the the woman's podcasts... not to mention the range of her work beyond 'reading erotica.'

That's 3 minutes including time to make a halfhearted skim of the notes from her podcasts (try <http://violetblue.libsyn.com/>), along w/ a quick skim of her written work... Amazon.com does nicely... looks like her books on fellatio and cunnilingus are selling well... 789/1,176 out of all books. (I, for one, am all in favor of more folks improving those skills.)

And attacking the name? How pathetic.

I mean, beyond my Aunt Dorrie (<http://www.houseochicks.com> is the home of The Original Vulva Puppet and Vulva University!) and Dr. Ruth, what media savvy sex educator does use their real name? OK, Dr. Drew. Forgot him. Maybe Dan Savage? (I still say that's just too convenient a last name...) It's San Francisco... the town has a history of being all about reinventing yourself.

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A few minutes of research might not have helped w/ the lack of tact in your response in front of Eve, but at least you wouldn't have been so woefully inaccurate in your knee-jerk dismissal.

That was just rude, Leo. P

Update: Leo Laporte responds to Patrick's email thusly (and kindly gave me permission to post it -- thank you, sir!):

My apologies - I did, in fact, confuse Violet Blue, podcaster, with Violet Blue, the porn star. Having taken Patrick's advice and done a little research I now see my mistake. I am sorry if I have offended Ms. Blue, please accept my apologies.

Posted By: [Eve Batey \(Email\)](#) | February 02 2007 at 04:01 PM

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COMMENTS

First off I don't get why they were dissing her in the first place. Isn't that a real waste of time & energy to diss someone's work when you aren't even familiar with it? But then again on 'Beauty and The Geek' - the geeks didn't understand what the word 'booty' meant and thought the girls were talking about pirate's treasure. If you want the treasure you need to put in some effort.

Posted By: Kitsune | February 02 2007 at 05:10 PM

wow -- thank you Patrick, and thank you Eve! the funny thing about my name is that's it's not a pseudonym. when Forbes put their list up, in the original bio they called me "pseudonymous" and I blogged the inaccuracy -- to which Forbes responded with a swift and sweet correction.

thank you, again.

Posted By: missvioletblue | February 02 2007 at 05:34 PM

I do have to say the fact that Leo, who is one of the most net-aware people in the world, doesn't even know who Violet Blue is says something about the validity of the Forbes list in the first place.

Posted By: Stewsburntmonk | February 03 2007 at 05:33 PM

Even if it was a direct stab @ violet blue. Seriously... who give a flying fuck. It was a stab @ sex writers like Regina Lynn and Violet lue and Dr. Ruth.... Not women.

Posted By: schwegler | February 04 2007 at 06:54 AM

As much as I like the interactive nature that the SF Gate site has taken on, sometimes I miss just actual news or culture *reporting*. Stuff like highlighting this feud just seems to glorify drama, name-dropping, social-status-checking and he-said she-said, and personally, I find it not only boring, but uninteresting to the point that I will avoid reading these blogs. I don't doubt Miss Blue's

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credentials, experience, or knowledge, but truth be told, this kind of "reporting" is self-indulgent and masturbatory - pun intended. I like reading about events and goings-on in the sex-positive culture of Our Fair City, but I wish it weren't so tied to the author as to make it seem like I'm reading someone's diary.

Posted By: honkshus | February 05 2007 at 01:04 AM

I've never seen so much virtual ink spilled over a single fragile, wounded ego. Violet, you'd appear more confident if you didn't eagerly leap to your own defense at every real or imagined slight. As it is, you appear alarmingly self-obsessed. I mean, who really cares what Leo Laporte thinks other than some fat, sweaty balding guys who have Doritos stuck in their keyboards?

Posted By: captjohnsmith | February 05 2007 at 09:40 PM

Jayzus, who cares?? This is the freakin' Chronicle, not Violet's LiveJournal, but you can't tell that from this kind of crap. The precious little "Blogger" tattoo doesn't help, either. Yuck.

Posted By: stikfa | February 06 2007 at 08:40 AM

a friend just emailed saying,
"It's always amusing to me when someone is dismissive and then responds to a legitimate complaint with "get over it." I don't think we tech girls should EVER "get over" discrimination in any form."

Posted By: missvioletblue | February 07 2007 at 02:31 PM

The thing is, Laporte and Dvorak weren't dismissive of "tech girls" in general. They were dismissive of you. There's a difference.

Posted By: captjohnsmith | February 07 2007 at 08:32 PM

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How Google Kept Apple's Search Ambitions in Check



By
Jon Victor

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Oct. 25, 2023 10:00 AM PDT

In 2014, Google executives were deeply concerned about a new **Apple** feature that gave users of its Safari web browser suggestions for websites to visit rather than routing them to **Google**, which was paying Apple to be the default search engine on that company's devices.

Google forecast a significant revenue hit from the feature, according to a slide deck that the U.S. Department of Justice made public this month as part of its **antitrust lawsuit** against the company; the government redacted how much revenue Google projected it would lose. By 2016, however, Google and Apple had changed their agreement to ensure that the iPhone maker kept its search product “substantially similar” to how it was in September 2016, according to court testimony and newly published internal emails.

THE TAKEAWAY

- Apple and Google altered their partnership in 2016 to limit Apple's moves in search
- Google had forecast a revenue hit from a Safari feature that diverted queries from its search engine
- Documents and testimony in the Google antitrust trial provide a window into the companies' dealings

The internal correspondence shows how Google sought to use its deal with Apple to prevent it from expanding its footprint in search and to protect Google's share of queries from Apple device users, which translated to billions of dollars in ad sales annually for Google. “We are trying to build a structure that prevents them from diverting queries and destroying value,” the Google executive in charge of overseeing the deal, Daniel Alegre, wrote in a June 2016 email, according to court transcripts.

The documents help explain why Apple has made only incremental changes to web search features on Safari and iOS, which it calls “Siri suggestions,” even as it has invested in acquiring technology and talent in the area. In the last decade, Apple acquired Topsy and Laserlike, two startups developing search technology. In 2018, it hired John Giannandrea, a former Google executive overseeing search, to lead its machine-learning and artificial intelligence efforts.

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Google as the default on its devices because it offers a better user experience than alternatives, not because the payments limit Apple's incentive to partner with another company or develop a competing product.

The Justice Department called its last witness to the stand last week as the trial enters a new phase. Over the past six weeks, government lawyers have questioned high-profile witnesses including **Microsoft** CEO Satya Nadella, Apple services chief Eddy Cue and Google ad executive Jerry Dischler. Much of the testimony has centered on the key question of whether Google's dominance in search and its agreements with other businesses have impeded competition, as the Justice Department alleges.

If the Justice Department prevails, it could force Google to alter or scrap its default search engine agreements with Apple, Samsung and other companies, potentially jeopardizing a significant amount of search traffic by making it easier for users to select alternatives. The trial is expected to conclude in mid-November.

Apple first agreed to make Google the default search engine in its browser in 2002. For a time, Safari only bypassed Google search results to send users to Wikipedia, according to court records. Beginning around 2015, though, Apple increasingly directed Safari users to websites, apps or Apple Maps pages, stoking tension between the tech giants.

When the pair revised their deal in 2016, the new arrangement permitted Apple to offer a "Siri suggestion," as its search feature in Safari is known, "exclusively for quality and not because they want to drive traffic to Siri," Joan Braddi, a Google executive overseeing search partnerships, wrote in an August 2018 email presented at trial. Testifying in the case earlier this month, Braddi said Apple has expanded its use of suggestions since then in spite of the agreement.

"Apple may have always been nervous about being so dependent on Google search and may have wanted to keep seeing if they could build something that's either better, or [that] would keep everything inside Apple eventually," said David Olson, a professor of antitrust law at Boston College Law School.

Apple continues to offer suggested non-Google websites to Safari users as they type queries in the browser. Still, court records show that Apple ultimately agreed not to expand its search feature significantly in order to preserve its lucrative revenue-sharing deal with Google.

Giannandrea testified in September that Apple offers its search feature in part to protect its customers' privacy and provide a better user experience. In recent years, Apple has expanded its web index so it can offer better results, Giannandrea said.

"Our general approach is we think users of our devices are seeking answers, and so if we can provide the answer, we will do that rather than sending them off to a general search engine," Giannandrea said. Apple has never agreed not to develop its own search engine, he said.

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Search partnerships elsewhere, and the projected revenue impact from Apple's search feature in the end was that “one person’s perspective.” Apple didn’t respond to a request for comment.

Siri’s suggestions could reemerge in the coming years as a point of contention as **Apple invests** to boost the voice assistant’s capabilities in light of advances in large language models, which can enable users to automate software tasks using normal language. Some of those tasks could involve web searches and therefore would be limited by Apple’s agreement with Google.

Secret Contract

The trial has provided an unprecedented look inside one of tech’s most important business relationships, in which Google pays Apple an estimated \$4 billion to \$7 billion annually to be the default search engine on Apple devices, according to the Justice Department. The contract is at the center of the U.S. government’s case against Google, which alleges that it is an illegal agreement that abuses the company’s monopoly power in web search. Google vehemently denies the charges.

U.S. District Judge Amit P. Mehta, who is hearing the case without a jury, has ruled that much of the evidence and testimony presented at trial should be limited from public view, despite motions from news organizations including The New York Times and Bloomberg to expand access to court proceedings. Many of the Justice Department’s witnesses have testified in closed sessions due to concerns from Google and other companies that the trial could reveal proprietary information. The Justice Department has posted select trial exhibits online, but they are just a fraction of the exhibits discussed during the six weeks of court proceedings.

The documents that have been released reveal the secrecy with which Google treated the details of its deal with Apple, including referring to Apple by code names such as “Andes” and “NYC” in internal correspondence. Some internal emails marked “attorney-client privilege,” which included Google lawyers as recipients, nonetheless surfaced in litigation because the senders were not soliciting legal advice.

Closing Loopholes

The 2016 change to the Apple deal wasn’t the only time Google rewrote its agreements with other companies to prevent competing features from undermining its default status on other platforms.

In September, the Justice Department presented evidence suggesting that Google had also used its search default deal with Samsung to prevent competition from Branch, a startup that developed a search engine that could index pages from apps rather than the web. Samsung had partnered with Branch to improve the search function on its devices.

Google executives overseeing its partnership with Samsung grew concerned in 2020 that Branch’s product had expanded from surfacing contacts, settings and photos to finding pages in apps like Yelp or Amazon, trial evidence shows. Google considered the feature a violation of its agreement with Samsung, with which it had a similar revenue-

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The same year, Google began to discuss expanding its deal with Samsung to prevent the phone maker from pre-installing any other search product connected to the internet, as opposed to one that searched the web, according to testimony from Branch's former CEO, Alex Austin. That move forced Branch to scale back the scope of its product significantly, Austin said.

"The reason that [the] DOJ was putting the evidence forward is because Google cut anybody off at the pass who might be trying any way to become a general search provider on the device," Megan Gray, a former lawyer at Google rival DuckDuckGo, said in an interview.

Jon Victor is a reporter at The Information covering Alphabet. He can be reached at jon.victor@theinformation.com or on Twitter at [@jon_victor_](https://twitter.com/jon_victor_).



Google CEO Sundar Pichai and Apple CEO Tim Cook. Photo by Getty.

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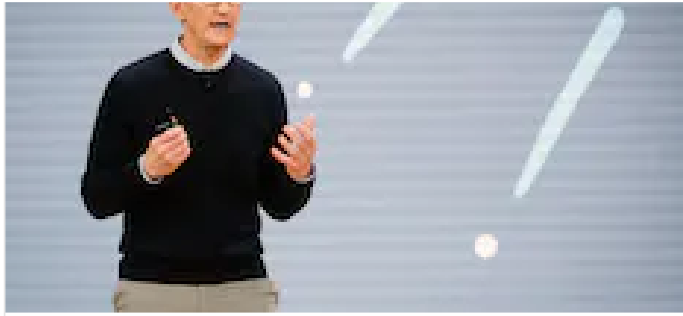
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